



Africa

Sierra Leone

Big butterfly

Found in the Sierra Leonean forests, the African giant swallowtail has a wingspan of up to 9 in (23 cm).



Star of Sierra Leone

Discovered in a mine near Koidu in 1972, this huge diamond weighed 969 carats. It is the fourth-largest gem-quality diamond ever found.



Support for survivors

In 1991–2002, a civil war ravaged Sierra Leone.

A young girl who suffered but survived, Mariatu Kamara set up a foundation in 2009 to support fellow victims.



Freetown

The capital and large port city is famous for its nearby beaches.



The Cotton Tree, Freetown

This mighty cotton tree has stood for centuries in the capital of Freetown. It is a protected, peaceful place, with historical and spiritual links.



Women processing garri in a factory.

Making garri

A staple food of Sierra Leone is cassava root ground into a type of flour called garri, which is used in many different ways in cooking.

Elaborate hairstyle

Stone sculpture

Sierra Leone is rich in masks and other forms of traditional art. This carved stone head is thought to date from the 15th century.



Sierra Leone, the “**Lion Mountains**,” takes its name from the dramatic range behind the capital, Freetown. It has some of West Africa’s highest **peaks** and stunning **beaches**. The biggest industries are **farming** and **mining**.

27,699 sq miles (71,740 sq km)

6.6 million

Freetown

Mende, Temne, Krio, English

